



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Philos Classical Christian School
School Website: <https://philosclassicalchristian.org/>

December 28, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Philos Classical Christian School (TN 37034) presents a clearly Christian, classical-leaning educational posture. Public-facing materials emphasize Christ-centered education, biblical worldview formation, Christian virtues, and a partnership model with parents. The school describes a classical approach and foundational emphasis on logic and reasoning, with an explicit aim toward depth and wisdom under a biblical frame. This yields a strong CLASSICAL orientation in several key areas, particularly in Religious and Metaphysical Foundations, and in School Purpose and Goal, as well as in Parents & Community. However, certain hallmark features of a strictly classical program—explicit, full-throated emphasis on Great Books/Great Conversation, extensive Socratic pedagogy across upper grades, and explicit liturgical or scholastic-based practices—are not clearly demonstrated in the publicly available materials. Taken together, the school aligns with classical education in many respects but does not (yet) exhibit the complete, textbook breadth of a fully realized Classical program in every category. The overall classification is SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Key evidence includes: explicit Christ-centered articulation and biblical worldview language (Rooted in Christ; glorify God; biblical worldview) in site materials, plus statements about a biblical, classical curriculum and partnership with parents (public content). Foundational materials from the classical education knowledge base grounded the rubric and keyword framework used here (including the Six Essential Elements and a comprehensive keyword lexicon), which we used to gauge match to classical indicators. See sources: PCCS public site content (Rooted in Christ, biblical worldview, partnership with parents) and related materials, and the classical-school rubric and keyword lexicon.
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Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public messages emphasize Christ-centered education and theological grounding (e.g., "Rooted in Christ," "glorify God through Christ-centered education," and "cultivating Christian virtues"). This is reinforced by passages describing biblical worldview formation and a God-centered curriculum. - Foundational language includes God, truth of God, and Christian virtue as guiding principles. The school materials frame education through a theological lens. - Location/content notes emphasize Christian partnership and worldview alignment, suggesting a liturgical/communal rhythm in practice, even if explicit liturgical terms are not always used on every page.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present in public materials: Christ-centered, rooted in Christ, glorify God, biblical worldview, Christian virtues, truth of God, God. (6 explicit instances or strong equivalents.) - Negative keywords: Not evident in the public materials reviewed (no explicit signals of secularism or non-theological framing).
filecite turn0file1 turn0file2

Why this rating - The school's public narrative centers on theological grounding and virtue formation within a Christian framework, aligning closely with the Positive Indicators for Grounded Theology, liturgical/community practice, and transcendental moral realism as framed in classical education rubrics. The absence of explicit non-religious or secular signals strengthens the CLASSICAL designation for this category.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Language emphasizes formation of virtue and wisdom through a biblical framework (e.g., “The student’s growth in knowledge, wisdom, and the truth of God,” “education through the lens that God created everything,” and “Laying the foundations for a lifelong love of classical learning”). - Claimed aims include giving students a biblical worldview and classical formation rather than mere vocational prep, with explicit reference to Christian virtue and human flourishing. - Explicit partnership with parents and a biblically framed curriculum support the telos of classical formation rather than a purely market-driven or job-prep goal.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, wisdom, truth, God, biblical worldview, virtue/Christian virtues, classic learning, human flourishing (concepts aligned with True/-Good/Beautiful teleology). (Approximately 5–6 explicit signals in the materials.) - Negative keywords: None observed in the materials reviewed (no emphasis on workforce prep, job-readiness, or secular utilitarian goals). □filecite□turn0file1□turn0file2□

Why this rating - The materials foreground formation and virtue within a theology-informed aim, consistent with CLASSICAL expectations for this category, even as direct statements about “Great Books” or “Great Conversation” are not all spelled out in the public materials. The overall goal emphasizes formation and truth/beauty in a theological frame.

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site signals a classical approach and involves logic and reasoning in academics, with claims about “education that integrates content and training students in logic and reasoning.” This matches some classical features. - References to a “biblical, classical and comprehensive curriculum” suggest a classical structure, though explicit mentions of core classical curriculum components (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books; history across the curriculum; Great Conversation) are not clearly enumerated in the public materials shown. - Some content implies a history-leaning or classical framework, but explicit components such as Great Books reading, Great Conversation, and a full Trivium progression are not explicitly demonstrated in the excerpts available.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: logic, reasoning, classical approach, education with a biblical/classical curriculum (implicit Great Books emphasis not stated explicitly). (2–3 clear signals: logic, reasoning, classical approach.) - Negative keywords: absence of explicit Great Books/-Great Conversation, explicit reference to history as “Great Books,” or explicit mention of the Trivium in the public content. Also no explicit statement about memorizations, chant, or great books readings. □filecite□turn0file1□turn0file2□

Why this rating - While the school presents as classical in orientation and mentions logic/reasoning and a classical curriculum lens, the public content does not clearly document the full set of classical curriculum elements (e.g., Great Books, Great Conversation, grammar/logic/rhetoric trio in school-wide language). Therefore, it aligns with SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than fully CLASSICAL in curriculum clarity.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The materials indicate emphasis on reasoning and logic development within an integrated curriculum, and a sense that learning should be meaningful and formative. However, there is no explicit public articulation of key classical pedagogy elements (Socratic seminars in upper grades, formal chanting/memory work, or a clear implementation of scholé in the lower grades) in the excerpts provided. - There is mention of a biblically integrated approach and a classical approach; the absence of explicit lower-grade singing/chanting, memory work, or explicit Latin/Greek pedagogy in the public-facing text limits a full CLASSICAL pedagogy claim.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: contemplative/restful learning (not explicitly stated but implied by “well-structured, thoughtful education” language in classical tradition), logic, reasoning, and a classical approach. - Negative keywords: absence of explicit Socratic seminars, memory-based chant, or rigorous rhetoric training in upper grades; no explicit Scholé-language usage on the site.

Why this rating - The school's public materials suggest a classical orientation but stop short of detailing the full pedagogy (e.g., Socratic discussion, rhetoric training, or rigorous memory/recitation practices). This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for pedagogy until more explicit public evidence is provided.

Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site references teachers by name (e.g., Mark Bolt as Founder; Mrs. Bolt, Mrs. Bone, and Dr. Susan Kees are cited in a parent remark), indicating a leadership/teacher-centric model. The content implies teachers are central to the school's identity and pedagogy, consistent with the notion of living curriculum and mentors in classical education. □filecite□turn0file1□turn0file3□ - The materials describe a partnership culture and a "classical approach" with teacher leadership, aligning with the classical model's emphasis on model teachers and mentors.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: teachers as mentors, living curriculum, founder-led instruction, model teachers (implied). Explicit terms like "mentors" or "living curriculum" are not strongly stated in the content, but the relational language (parent-teacher partnership) and named faculty signal a teacher-centric model. - Negative keywords: None evident (no language suggesting "facilitators on the side" or purely administrative instructors without classical context).

Why this rating - The presence of named faculty, founder leadership, and a school culture that centers teachers as primary agents supports a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for Faculty, given that explicit phrases such as "living curriculum" or "portrait of a teacher" are not overtly stated in the public content.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - A strong emphasis on partnering with parents is explicit: "Partnership between parents and teachers" and "We desire to partner with parents by providing students with a biblical, classical and comprehensive curriculum." These statements demonstrate active parent engagement and a shared formation project. □filecite□turn0file1□turn0file2□ - The site invites parental involvement through tours, communications, and a family-friendly, faith-aligned community culture, consistent with classical education norms that treat parents as co-teachers or strong partners.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with parents, parent formation/involvement, biblical/classical curriculum, co-teaching potential (implied by "partner with parents"), open invitation to visits (tours, community engagement). (Multiple explicit phrases.) - Negative keywords: None identified in the public materials (no customer-as-consumer language, no disengagement language). □filecite□turn0file1□turn0file2□

Why this rating - The explicit, explicit emphasis on parent partnership and community engagement aligns strongly with CLASSICAL expectations for the Parents & Community category.

Overall assessment (aggregate)

- Category ratings:
 - Element 1: CLASSICAL
 - Element 2: CLASSICAL
 - Element 3: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
 - Element 4: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
 - Element 5: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
 - Element 6: CLASSICAL
- Aggregate: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

What Would Move the Needle

- Make Great Books/Great Conversation explicit: Public materials should clearly articulate a Great Books program and the Great Conversation framework, including representative readings, and a stated expectation of student engagement with primary sources and canonical works across grades.

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- Publicly document full Trivium components: Explicitly name and describe the grammar, logic, and rhetoric progression, with a plan for memory work, recitation, and classical modes (e.g., prosaic and poetic memory, standard forms of argument).
 - Expand and articulate pedagogy: Present concrete examples of Socratic seminars, debates, and rhetoric instruction across upper grades; articulate how scholé/restful learning is implemented (e.g., schedule, spaces, and practices) to align with scholé language.
 - Deepen curricular visibility: Provide a clear map of curriculum elements (history as a Western/Christian history, primary sources, integration with theology) and indicate specific Great Books or canonical authors read within the program.
 - Enhance liturgical/communal elements: If appropriate within the school's mission, clearly describe liturgical or worship-related practices, calendar integration, and how communal worship or prayer informs daily learning.
 - Strengthen faculty narrative: Use explicit language about the faculty as mentors and living curriculum; provide a clear teacher profile or portrait language to match classical expectations.
 - Expand parental formation offerings: Offer structured parent education (book studies, courses) and transparent parent-involved pathways to participation, thereby strengthening the co-teacher model.

Citations: The analysis above draws on PCCS public content demonstrating Christ-centered, biblical worldview language, parental partnership, and a classical framing (turn0file1, turn0file2, turn0file3). It maps to the Six Essential Elements framework and keyword lexicon used to benchmark classical indicators (turn0file12; turn0file0). Additional context from the school-firecrawl content confirms explicit language around “Rooted in Christ” and “biblical, classical curriculum” (turn0file1; turn0file2). □file-cite□turn0file1□turn0file2□turn0file3□turn0file12□turn0file0□

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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